Itmam user guide

Arabic word suggestions as you type on your keyboard, in any Windows app.

Version 1.2 · https://nasmn77.github.io/Itmam/en/

The pictures in this guide are from the app itself, with sample data.

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1. What Itmam is

Itmam suggests Arabic words while you type on your keyboard, the way a phone does: a small bar appears above the caret with the closest words to what you started typing, and one key inserts the one you want.

- **In every app:** Notepad, Word, browsers, email and most apps, with no setup.
- **A large dictionary:** about 880,000 words from everyday Arabic and Arabic Wikipedia.
- **Learns from you:** the words you use become suggestions, and the ones you use most come first.
- **Saves repeated typing:** completes well-known phrases, turns your shortcuts into full text, and inserts long replies of several lines.
- **Private:** it sends no data and does not save your text.

2. Before you start

An Arabic keyboard layout

Itmam works only while you type with an Arabic layout. To add one: Windows Settings → Time & language → Language & region → Add a language → Arabic. Switch layouts with `Alt` + `Shift` or `Win` + `Space`. With an English layout Itmam does nothing.

Where is Itmam?

Itmam opens no window: it runs in the notification area next to the clock, and its icon is a bar with the letter «ت». When it starts, an "Itmam is running" notification appears. If you cannot see the icon, click the ^ arrow next to the clock.

Click the icon with either mouse button to open its menu (chapter 8).

Start with Windows

Itmam can start automatically with Windows: Settings → General → "Start with Windows".

3. Typing with suggestions

Type the first two letters of a word, and the bar appears above the caret.



Choosing a suggestion

- `Tab` inserts the first suggestion, the one highlighted in the selection color.
- `Ctrl` + `2` or `3`… inserts a suggestion by its number. Numbers can be shown on the bar (Appearance).
- With the arrow keys: `↑` moves into the bar, `←` `→` choose, `Enter` inserts, `Esc` or `↓` leaves.
- Or click the suggestion.
- `Esc` hides the bar until you type the next letter.

After inserting, Itmam adds a space (can be turned off in General), but not when a space or punctuation already follows the caret.

Picked the wrong one?

Press `Backspace` right after inserting, and what you typed comes back.

It understands how you type

- **Without hamza:** «احمد» finds «أحمد», and «ان» offers «أن», «إن» and «أنا».
- **With attached letters:** the article and attached conjunctions and prepositions: «والمد» finds «والمدرسة».
- **Common mistakes:** «لاكن» offers «لكن» first, and «انشاءالله» offers «إن شاء الله». Nothing is replaced automatically: you choose.
- **From the middle of a word:** go back into a word with a click or `Backspace`, and Itmam completes it from the caret.

> No suggestions appear while text is selected, in password fields, in excluded apps, or in full-screen games.

4. Your call from the bar: right-click

Right-click any suggestion, and buttons appear above it:

- **Delete:** for a word Itmam learned from you: it is forgotten (and learned again if you use it). For a phrase: removed from your phrases, or hidden if it is built in.
- **Block:** for a word you never want: it is never suggested, even if it is in the dictionary. Unblock it in "My words".
- **Add to My phrases:** for a phrase, to keep it.

From the keyboard: while choosing with the arrows, `Ctrl` + `Delete` forgets the selected learned word.

5. Phrases

Itmam knows about 250 common phrases: greetings, remembrance, prayers, occasions and formal letters. Type the start of one and it offers the rest:

- After « بسم» it offers «الله الرحمن الرحيم», and `Tab` inserts it whole. Or keep going word by word.
- **Your own:** your signature or your organization's name, added in "My phrases", are suggested first.
- **Learned phrases:** words you type in a row twice (2 to 5 words) are learned as a phrase. Sequences not repeated are deleted after 30 days. This can be turned off.

6. Text shortcuts

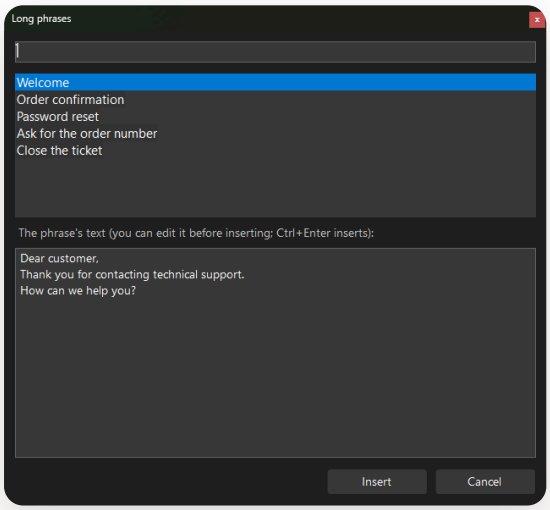
A short code you type: the bar offers its text first, and `Tab` puts it in place of the code. For example, type «ع1» and it offers «السلام عليكم ورحمة الله وبركاته».

A code starts with an Arabic letter and may be followed by digits. Add yours in Settings → "Text shortcuts". A code is never replaced automatically: «ع1» stays as it is unless you press `Tab`.

7. Long phrases

Replies of several lines you write often, such as support answers: the greeting, asking for the order number, the password reset steps, closing the ticket.

1. Save each reply once in Settings → "Long phrases" → "Add": a name you know it by, and a text of up to 4,000 characters over several lines.
2. In any app, press `Ctrl` + `Shift` + `Space`: a list of your replies opens.
3. Type part of a name or of the text to filter it, and move with the arrow keys while you see the reply's text below the list.
4. Press `Enter` or "Insert": the reply is pasted at the caret with its lines as you wrote them. `Esc` or "Cancel" closes the list.



The long phrases list, with search and the selected reply's text.

Editing a reply before inserting it

The reply's text below the list can be edited: click in it and change what you like. `Enter` there starts a new line and `Ctrl` + `Enter` inserts. When you insert after an edit, Itmam asks: "Yes" saves the edit in the phrase, then inserts it; "No" inserts the edited text this time only. Choosing another reply or closing the list drops the edit.

> The reply is inserted through the clipboard; Itmam then puts back what was on your clipboard, and the reply stays out of clipboard history.

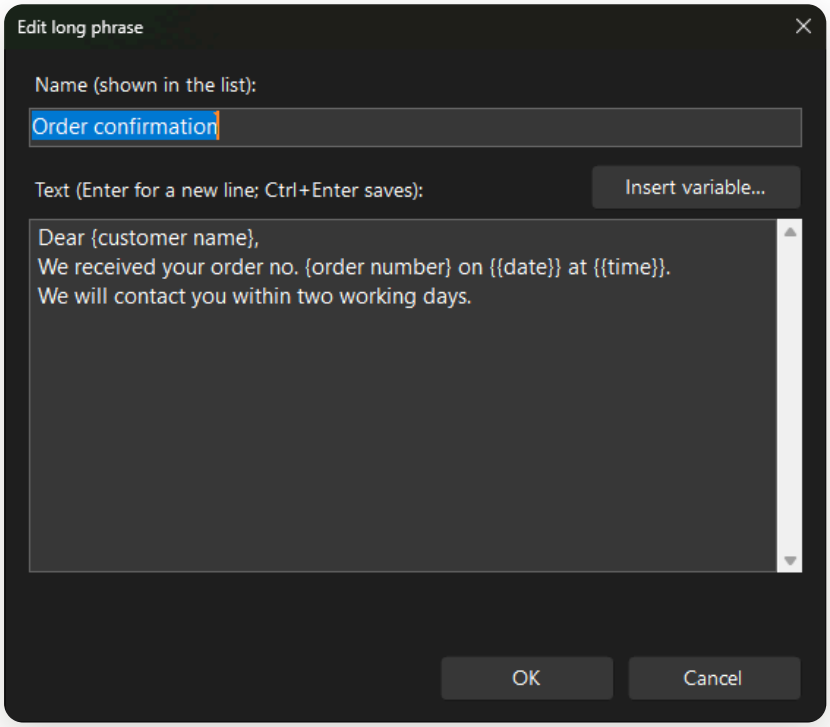
For support teams

Export the approved replies to a text file and import it on your colleagues' PCs, so everyone sends the same wording. Importing adds to what each person has and removes nothing.

Long phrases: variables

Write the reply once and leave places for what changes each time: the customer's name, the order number, today's date.

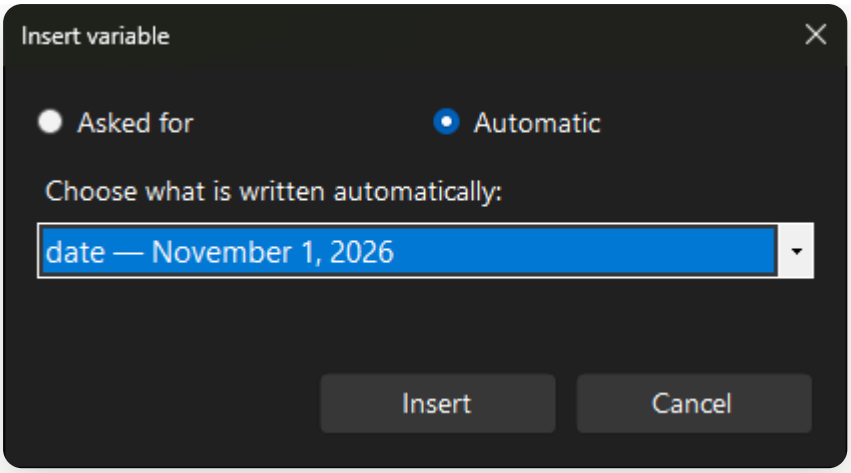
- **Asked for `{customer name}`**: in braces; Itmam asks for its value when you insert the reply. If it appears more than once, you type it once.
- **Automatic `{{date}}`**: in double braces; Itmam writes it by itself. There are four: the date, the Hijri date (Umm al-Qura calendar), the day and the time. They are written in Arabic in an Arabic reply and in English in an English one.



"Insert variable…" puts the variable at the caret.

Inserting a variable

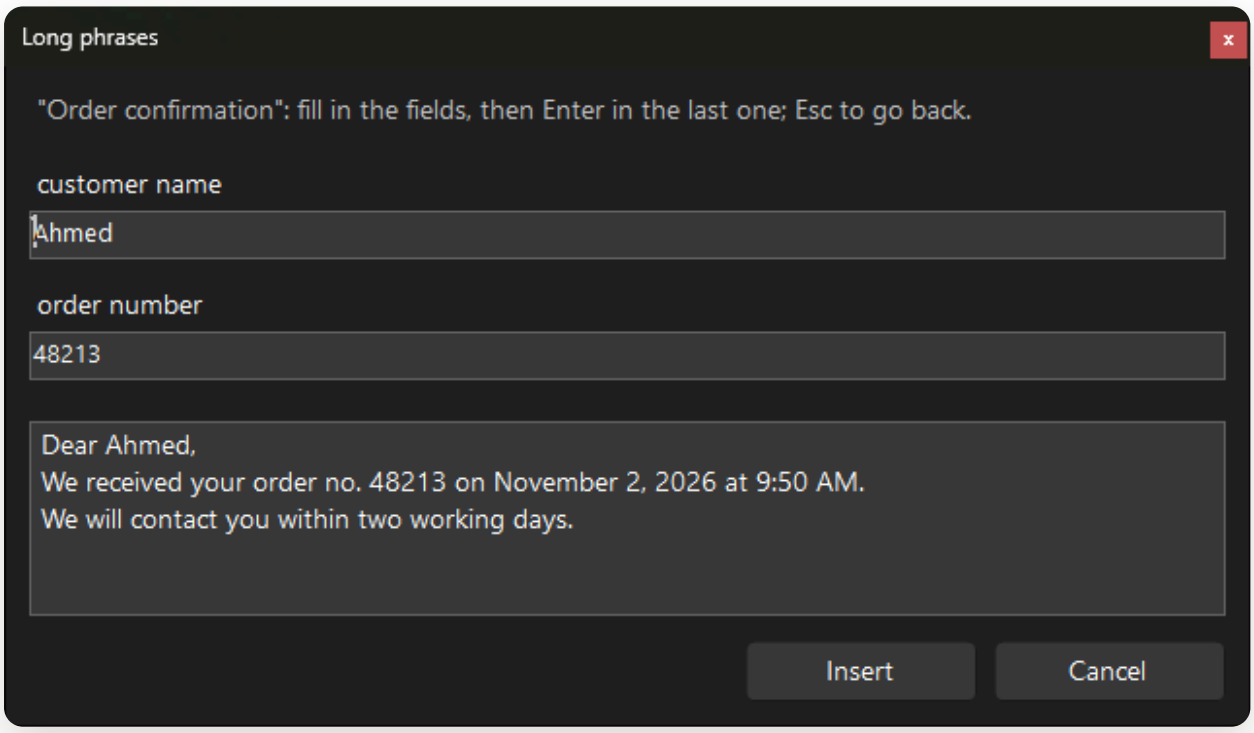
In the long phrase window, press "Insert variable…", then choose: "Asked for" and type its name, or "Automatic" and pick it from the list. Itmam types the braces for you. You can also type a variable asked for yourself; automatic ones are picked from the list, and any other name in double braces is refused when saving.



Filling in the variables

Choose the reply in the long phrases list and press `Enter`: a field appears for each variable asked for, and the reply below follows what you type. `Tab` moves between fields, `Enter` in the last one or "Insert" inserts the reply, and `Esc` or "Cancel" goes back to the list. If a field is left empty, Itmam asks before inserting. A reply without variables is inserted at once, as before.

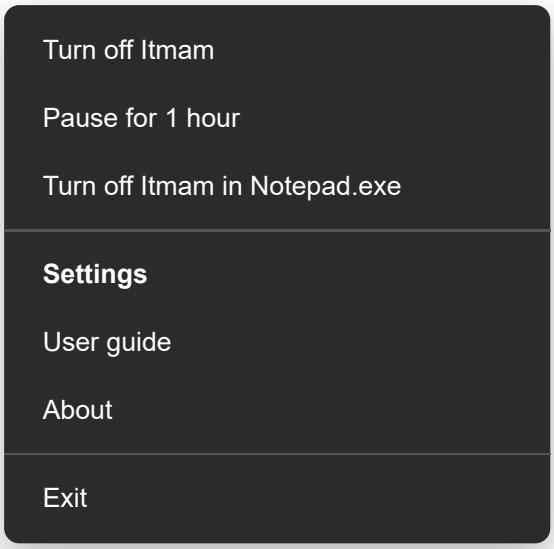
You can also edit the filled reply itself, for this time only: the fields are then locked so they do not overwrite your edit, and the reply is inserted as you edited it.



> The values you type are not saved; they are forgotten after inserting.

8. The tray menu

Click Itmam's icon next to the clock with either mouse button:

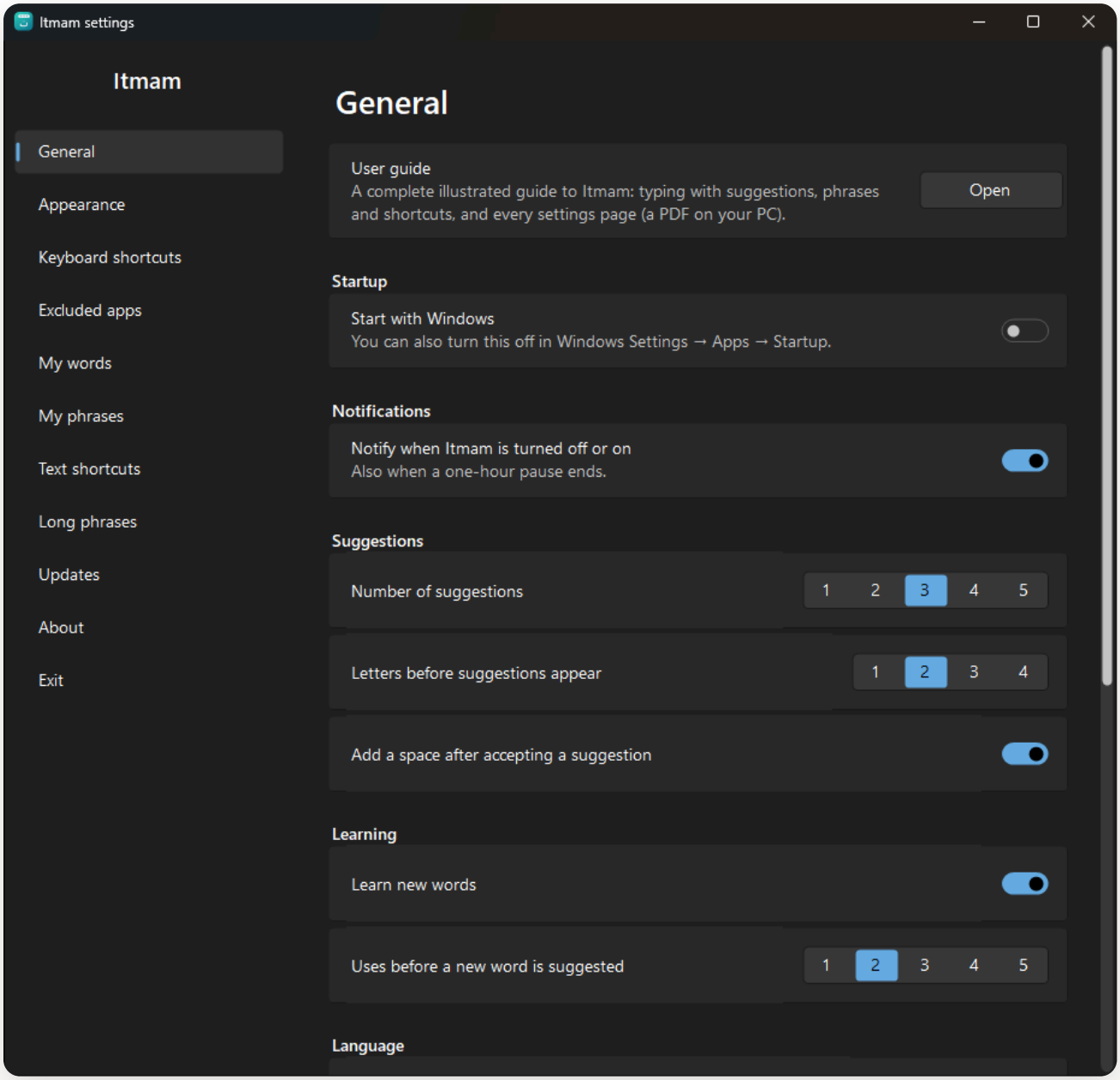


- **Turn off / Turn on Itmam:** stops and restores the suggestions, remembered after a restart. The same from the keyboard: press `Ctrl` + `Alt` and release them.
- **Pause for 1 hour:** Itmam comes back by itself after an hour, or choose "Resume now".
- **Turn off Itmam in …:** named after the last app you typed in; it is added to the excluded apps after a confirmation.
- **Settings**, **User guide** and **About**.
- **Exit:** closes Itmam completely until you start it from the Start menu or sign in again.

Small notifications appear when Itmam is turned off or on (can be turned off), and when an update is available in the Store.

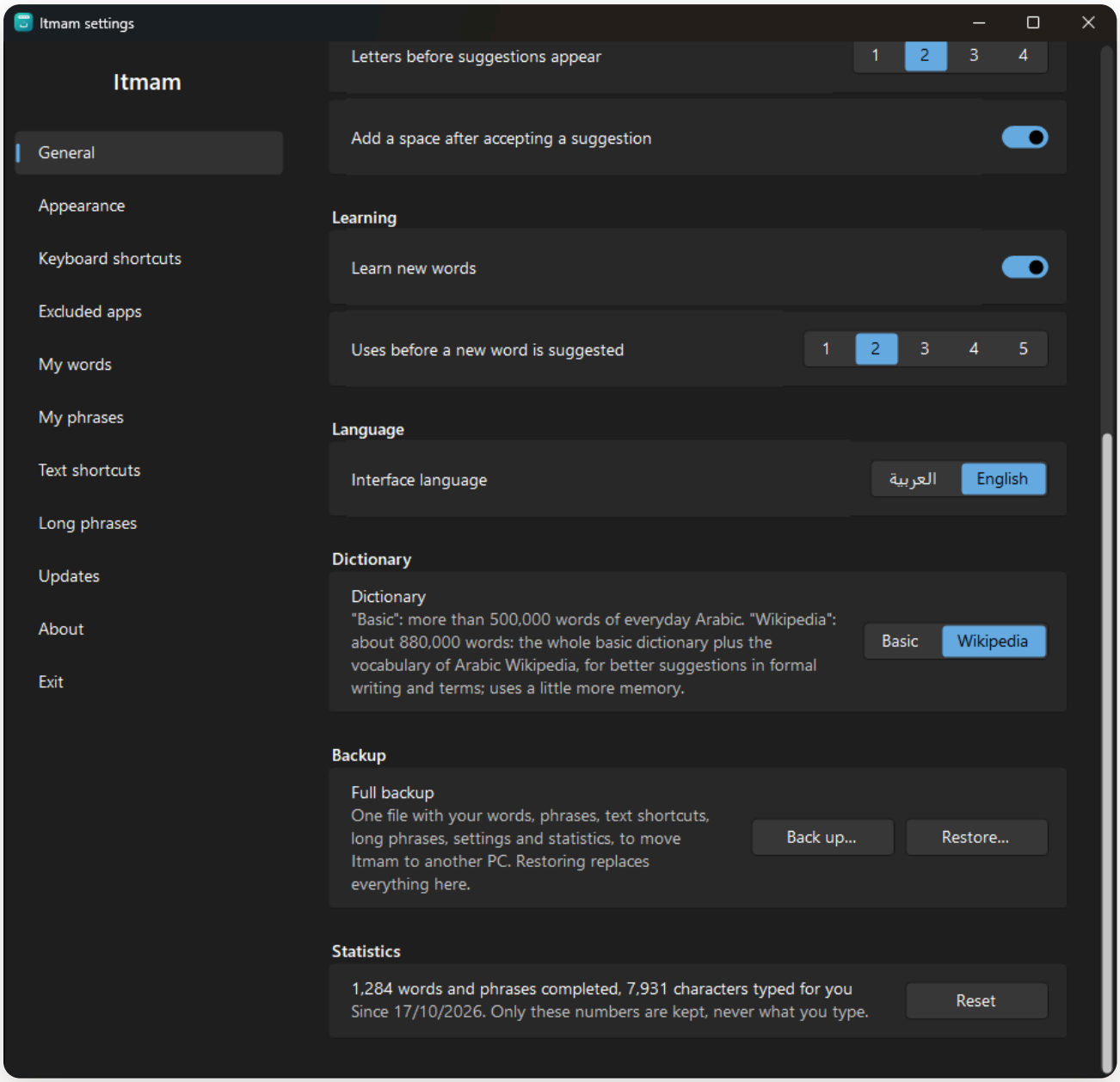
9. Settings: General

Open Settings from the tray menu. The pages are listed on the left, and every change applies at once.



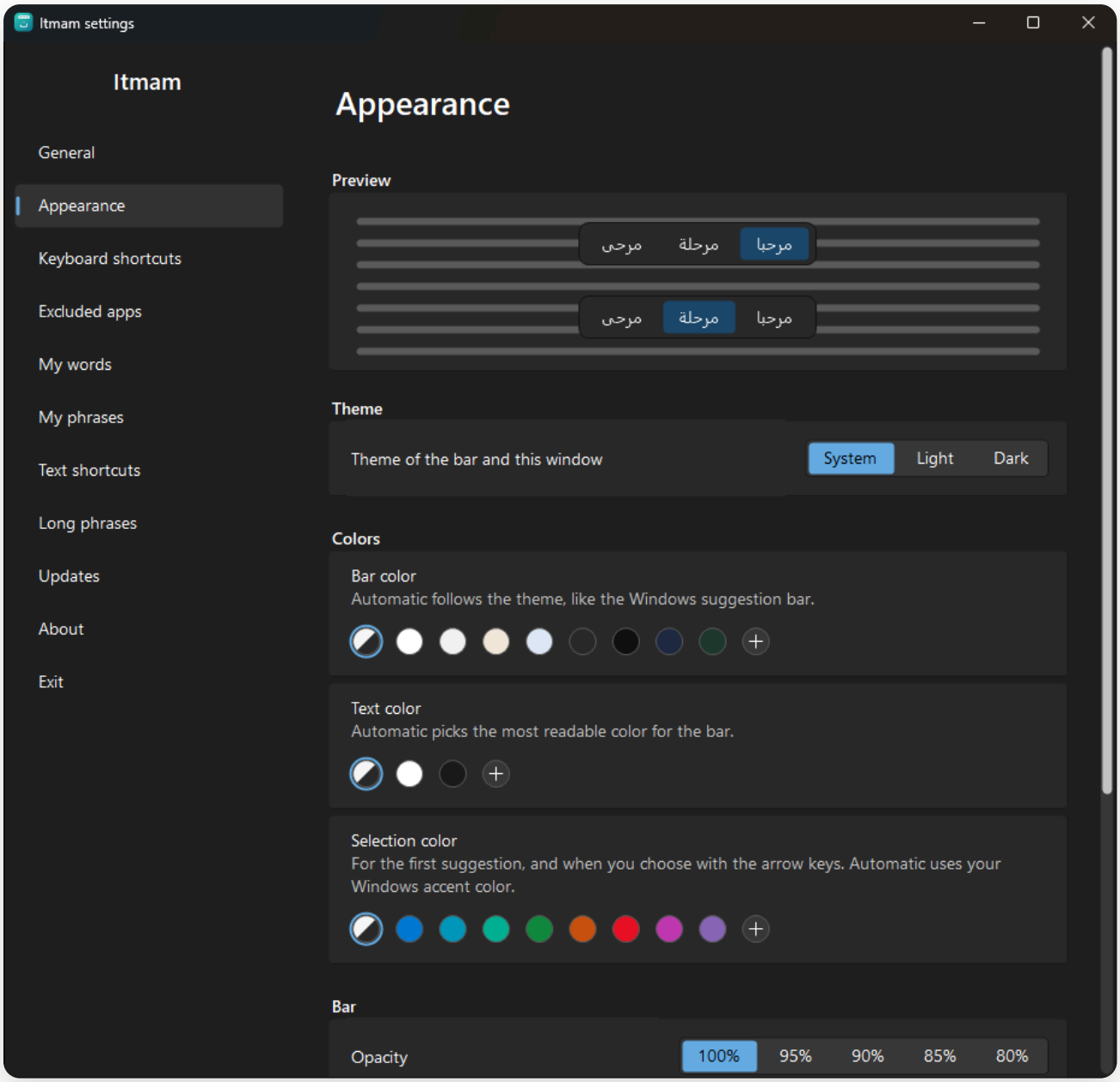
- **User guide:** opens this guide.
- **Start with Windows**, and **Notify when Itmam is turned off or on**.
- **Suggestions:** how many the bar shows (1 to 5), letters before they appear, and a space after accepting.
- **Learning:** learn new words or not, and how many uses before a new word is suggested.
- **Language:** the interface language, Arabic or English.

General: dictionary, backup, statistics



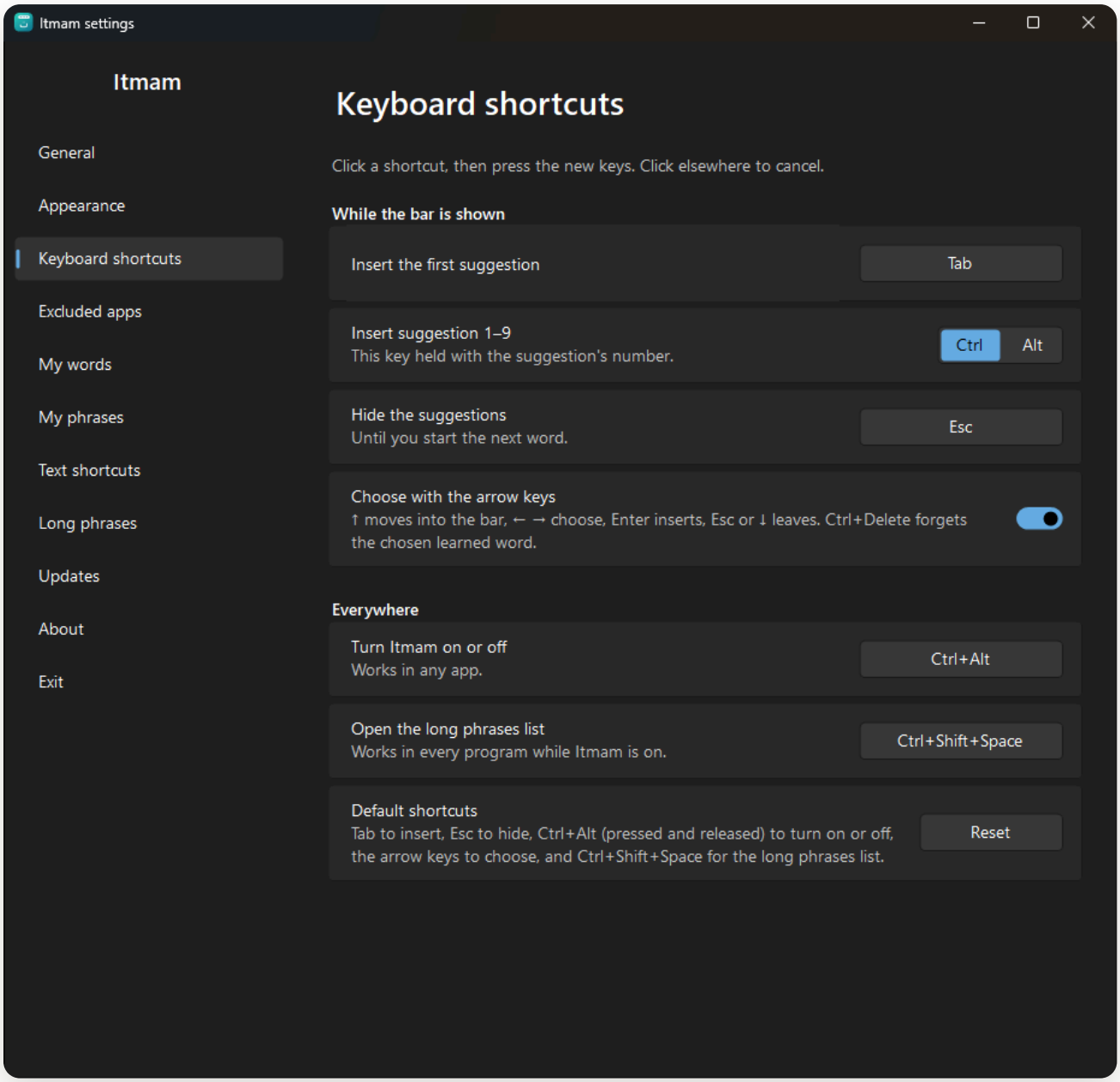
- **Dictionary:** "Wikipedia" (the default), about 880,000 words: the basic dictionary plus the vocabulary of Arabic Wikipedia for formal writing and terms. "Basic": more than 500,000 words, using less memory.
- **Full backup:** one file (.itmam) with your words, phrases, text shortcuts, long phrases, settings and statistics, to move Itmam to another PC. "Restore" replaces everything on this PC with the file's content, after a confirmation.
- **Statistics:** how many words and phrases Itmam completed and how many characters it typed for you. Only these two numbers are kept.

10. Appearance



- **Theme:** System, Light or Dark, for the bar and the settings window.
- **Colors:** bar, selection and text. "Automatic" picks the most readable color, and a warning appears if the text gets hard to read.
- **Bar:** opacity, text size, highlighting the first suggestion, and showing suggestion numbers.
- A live preview at the top; "Reset to the Windows look" resets everything.

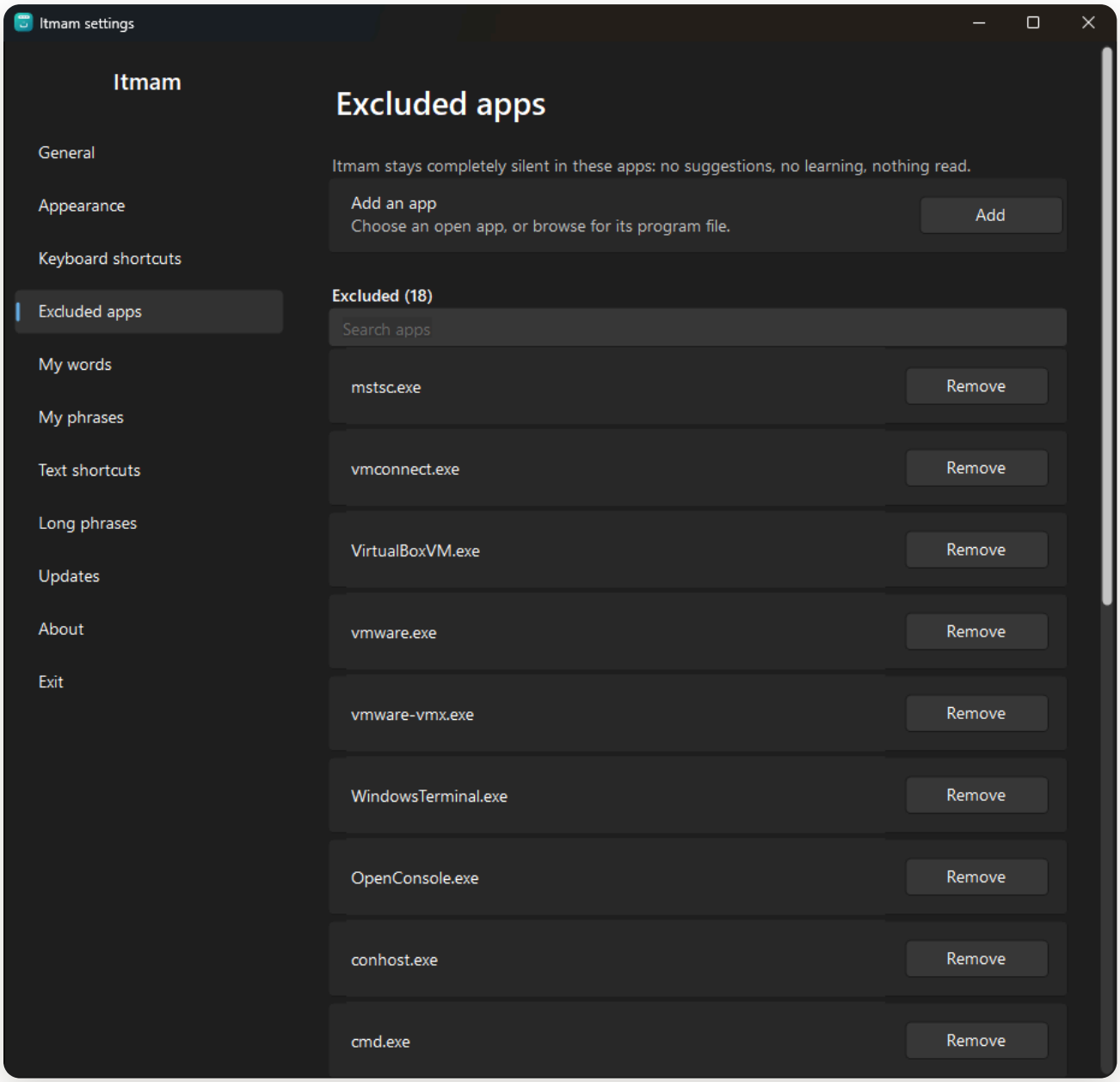
11. Keyboard shortcuts



Click a shortcut, then press the new keys; click elsewhere to cancel. Itmam refuses shortcuts that type text or clash with common Windows shortcuts, and says why.

- **While the bar is shown:** insert the first suggestion (`Tab`), insert by number (`Ctrl` or `Alt` with the number), hide (`Esc`), and choosing with the arrow keys.
- **Everywhere:** turn Itmam on or off (`Ctrl` + `Alt`), and open the long phrases list (`Ctrl` + `Shift` + `Space`).

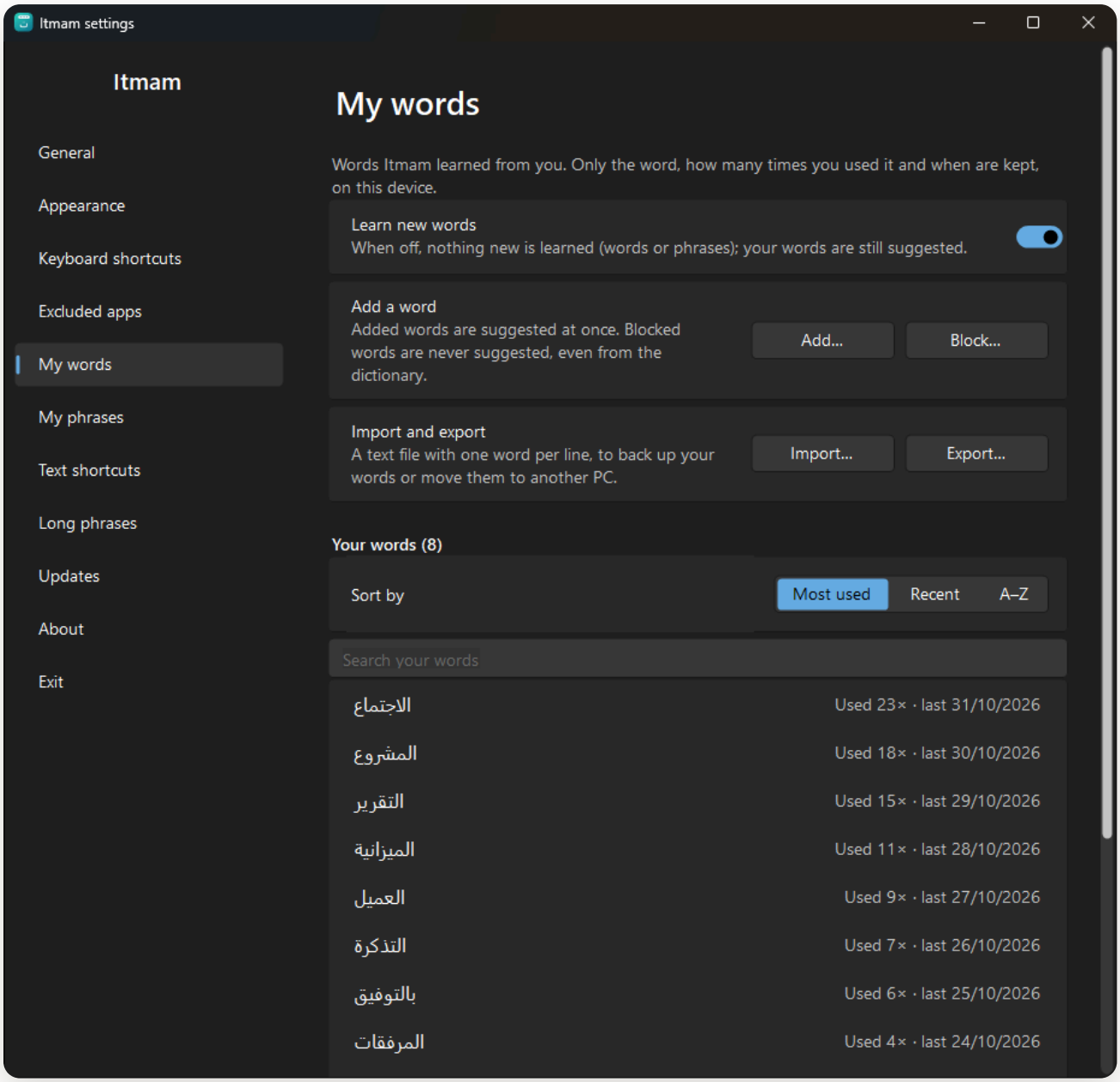
12. Excluded apps



Itmam stays completely silent in these apps: no suggestions, no learning, nothing read.

- **Add an app:** from the open apps, or "Browse…" for its program file.
- The default list holds remote desktop, virtual machines, terminals and game launchers.
- Quickest: "Turn off Itmam in …" from the tray menu while you are in the app.

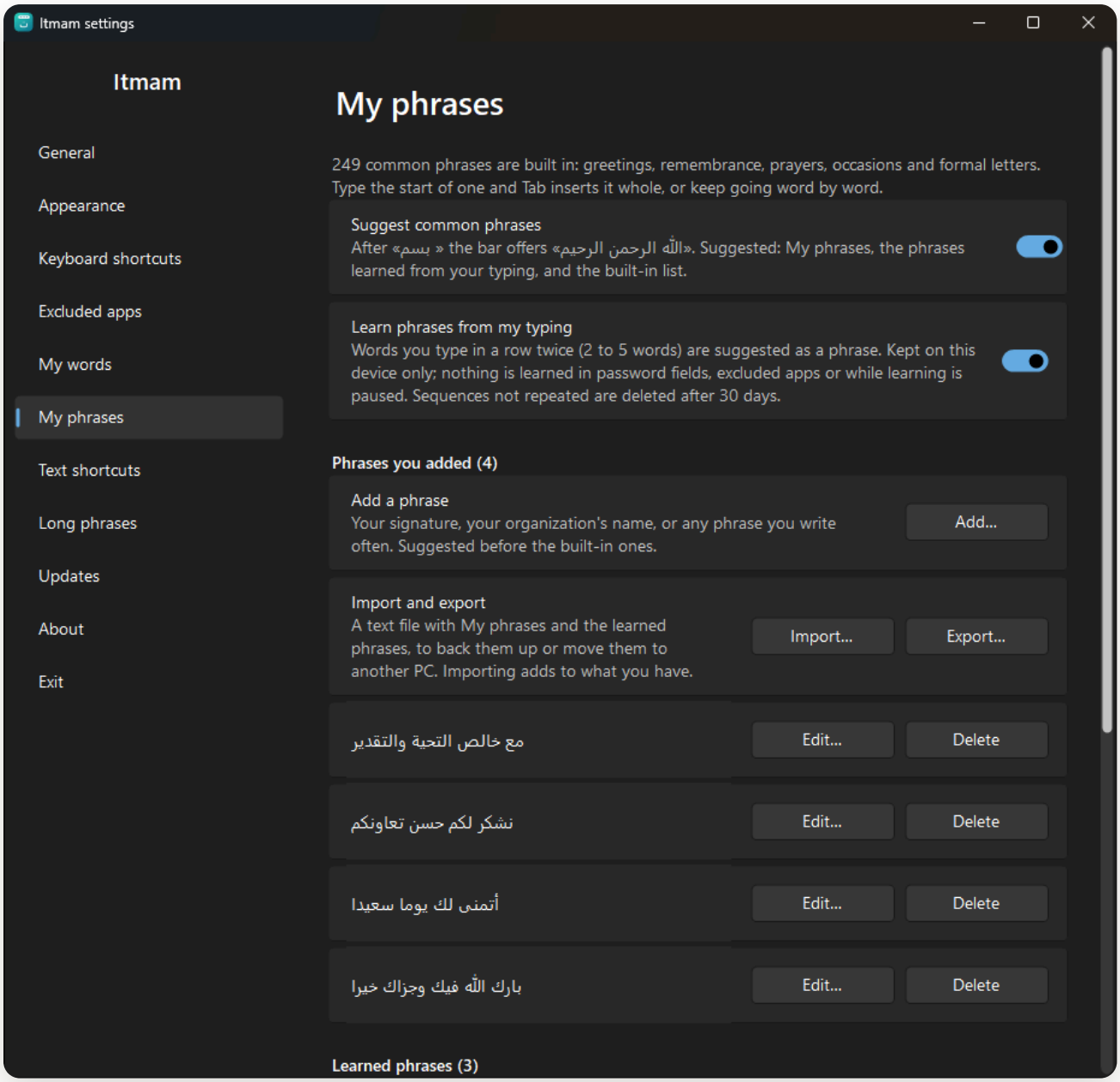
13. My words



The words Itmam learned from you. Only the word, how many times you used it and when are kept, on this PC only.

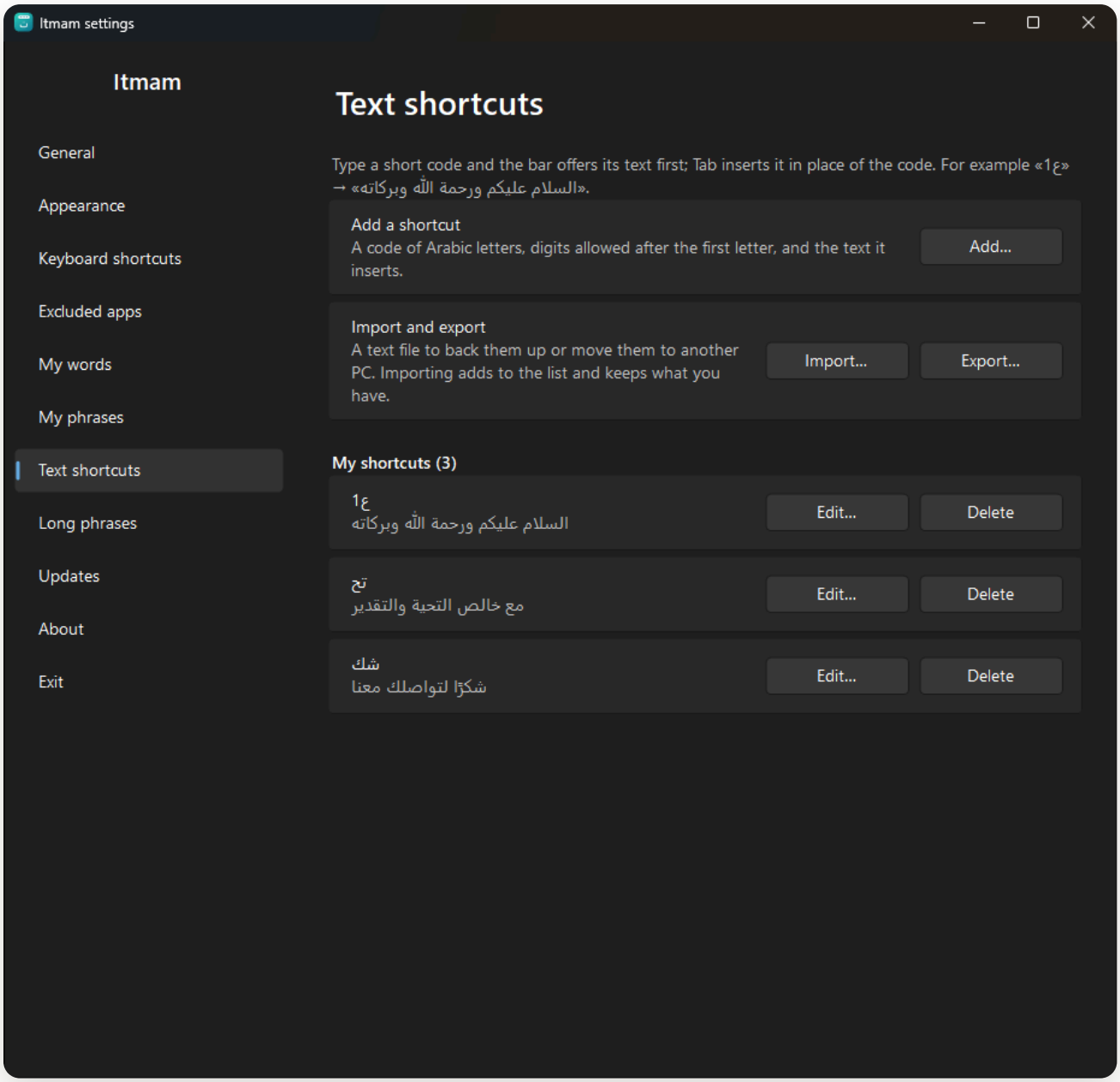
- **Learn new words:** when off, nothing new is learned, and your words are still suggested.
- **Add:** a word suggested at once. **Block:** a word never suggested, even if it is in the dictionary.
- The list sorts by most used, recent or A–Z, with search. Click a word to edit, block or delete it.
- **Import and export:** a text file with one word per line. "Delete all my words" cannot be undone.

14. My phrases and text shortcuts



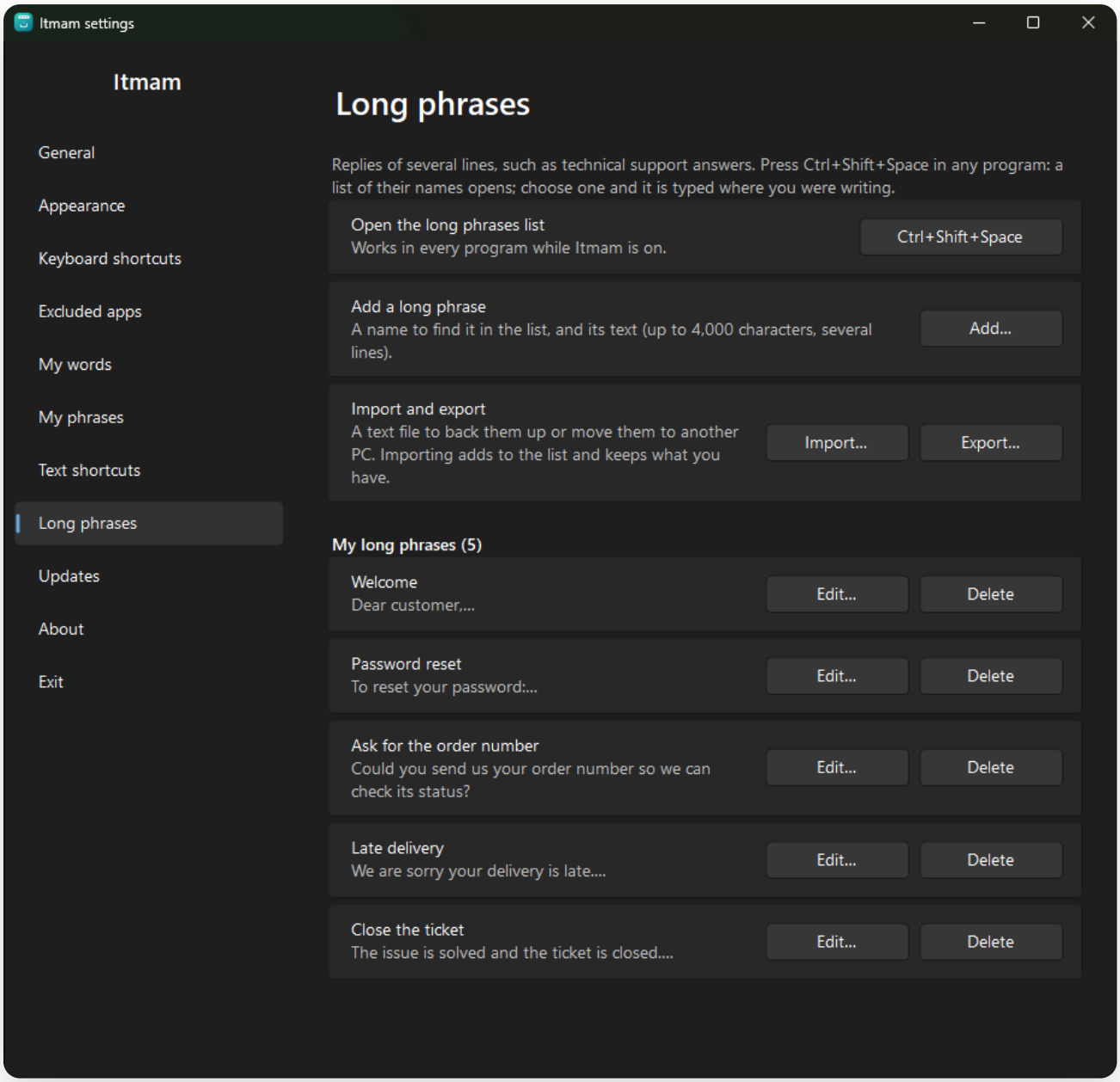
- **Suggest common phrases** and **Learn phrases from my typing**: each can be turned off.
- **Phrases you added:** add, edit and delete, import and export.
- **Learned phrases:** all of them, to move to your phrases or delete.
- **Deleted built-in phrases:** the ones you hid from the bar, restorable here.

Text shortcuts



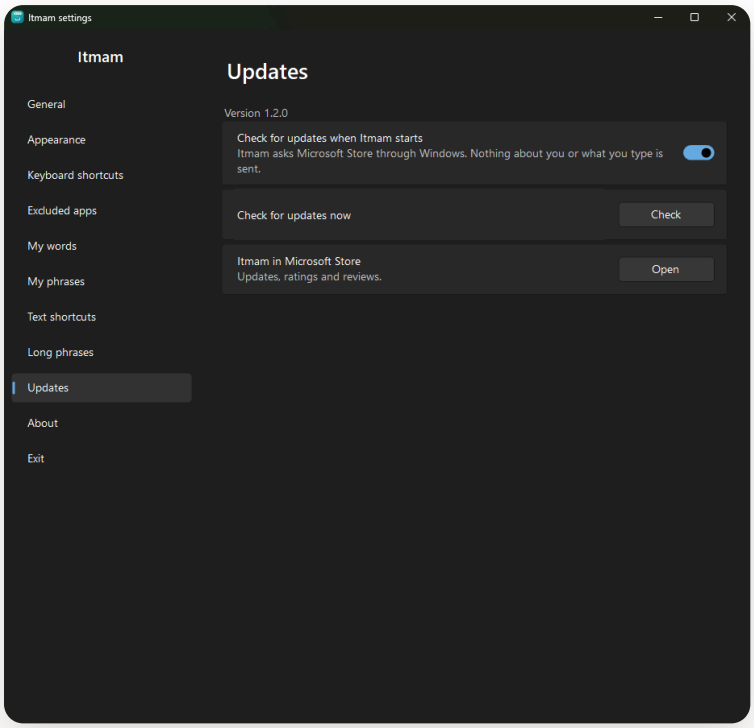
- **Add a shortcut:** the code (such as «1ع») and the text it puts in.
- Edit or delete any shortcut in the list, and move them all to another PC with import and export.

15. Long phrases in Settings

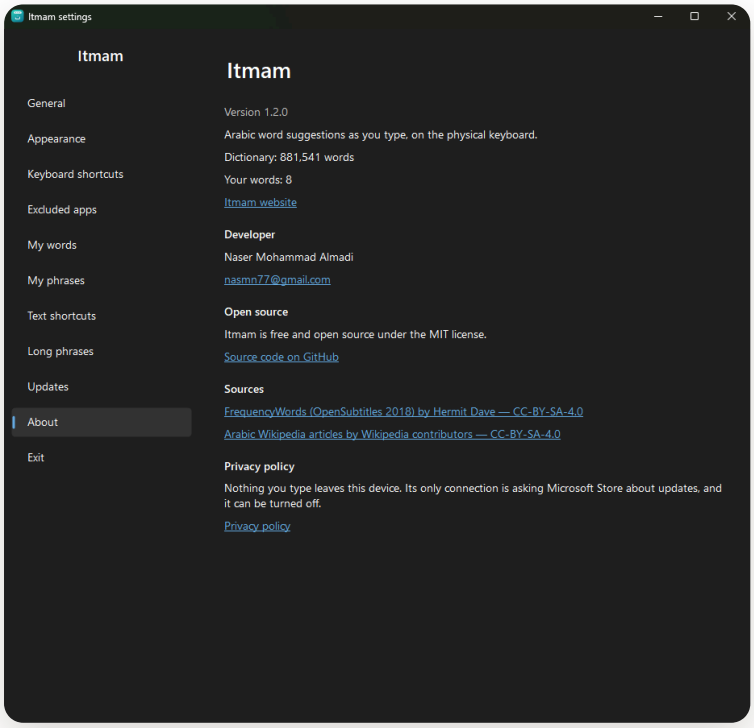


- **Open the long phrases list:** the shortcut; click it to change it.
- **Add a long phrase:** a name (up to 60 characters) and the text (up to 4,000 characters), with "Insert variable…" for the customer's name, today's date and more (see "Long phrases: variables"). In the text box, `Enter` starts a new line and `Ctrl` + `Enter` saves.
- Edit and delete; import and export to share them with colleagues.

16. Updates and About



Updates: at start-up Itmam asks Microsoft Store whether a newer version exists (can be turned off), and "Check" asks now. The update itself comes through the Store.



About: the version, the dictionary and your word counts, the Itmam website, contacting the developer, the source code, the dictionary sources, and the privacy policy.

17. Privacy

- **Sends no data:** no statistics, no crash reports. Its only connection is asking Microsoft Store about updates, and it can be turned off.
- **Your text is not saved:** only the words and short phrases you repeat, with how many times you used them, on your PC.
- **Silent where it should be:** nothing is read from password fields, excluded apps, or apps running as administrator.
- **Open source:** anyone can review the code on GitHub.

Full privacy policy: https://nasmn77.github.io/Itmam/en/privacy.html

18. Troubleshooting

The bar does not appear

- Make sure the keyboard layout is Arabic.
- Make sure Itmam is on: its icon is next to the clock, and its menu says "Turn off Itmam", not "Turn on Itmam".
- Is the app excluded? Running as administrator? Full screen?
- The bar appears after the number of letters set in General (two by default).

The bar is not at the caret

Some apps do not tell Windows where the caret is, so Itmam places the bar at the text field or at the mouse. Typing and inserting still work.

An odd word keeps being suggested

Right-click it, then "Delete" if it was learned, or "Block" so it is never suggested.

Moving Itmam to a new PC

General → "Back up…" on the old PC, then "Restore…" on the new one.

Bug reports

Found a problem? Write to us on GitHub, where a ready "Bug report" form is waiting:

https://github.com/nasmn77/Itmam/issues

For anything you would rather not post publicly: nasmn77@gmail.com. Please do not paste private text in a report.

19. Shortcut summary

Keys	What they do
`Tab`	Insert the first suggestion
`Ctrl` + `1` … `9`	Insert a suggestion by its number
`↑` then `←` `→` then `Enter`	Choose with the arrows, then insert
`Esc`	Hide the suggestions until the next letter
`Backspace`	Right after inserting: undo it
`Ctrl` + `Delete`	While choosing with the arrows: forget the selected learned word
`Ctrl` + `Shift` + `Space`	The long phrases list, in any app
`Ctrl` + `Alt`	Turn Itmam off or on from anywhere (press, then release)

Every shortcut can be changed in Settings → "Keyboard shortcuts".